



Baidu overtakes Google

At 3700 percent year-over-year growth, the Chinese search giant is #2 in the global smart speaker market. <https://digit.in/sep19-37>



First ever space crime allegations

NASA is reportedly investigating what's said to be the first ever instance of a space crime. <https://digit.in/sep19-38>

listening officers closely monitor both internal and external communication channels. They bridge the gap between simply 'hearing' the employees of an organisation to actually 'listening' to what they have to say. Hearing is passively acknowledging someone's issue while real listening is often associated with counselling or conflict resolution. It is all about building rapport, understanding and trust with the employees.

Therefore, chief listening officers have the primary focus of gathering information from customers and employees so that they can develop efficacious methods for a business or organisation to enhance the quality of their relationship with both.

When it comes to qualifications, chief listening officers must possess a wide variety of skills in domains such as public relations, business, social media management and marketing. They are also required to have a Master's Degree as a minimum requirement, in fields such as business administration, human resources or

departments and also try to listen around in communities, forums, meetings and more to stay on top of gossip, chats, and interactions. Chief Listening Officers are also responsible for letting customers or employees know what action or path has been taken on the basis of their feedback and comments which assures them that the company actually cares and is not just paying lip-service.

In order to become a successful listening organisation, a chief listening officer first sets goals for themselves, be it measuring sentiment or monitoring the effectiveness of marketing strategies. They also attempt to monitor wider trends and insights which will ultimately lead to better customer satisfaction. They also ensure that the listening process never stops. Many companies begin social media engagement as a means to use the findings to create their market-

ing strategy and then forget about it. A chief listening officer ensures that the brand keeps listening, and makes adjustments to the approach as the market shifts.

The first Chief Listening Officer

at Kodak, Beth LaPierre states that data mining and figuring out who needs this mined information is also a big part of the job. "We get about 300,000 new mentions of Kodak every month and we don't censor the comments or videos people create about our company. I define how we handle this data via technology and tools", LaPierre told AdAge.com. She also stated that chief listening officers make the call on who needs the information she's acquired - the marketing team or the product team. It's a role that encompasses many job profiles in one and the candidates are

required to have expertise in their particular field.

EVERY CEO MUST BE A CHIEF LISTENING OFFICER

Innovative ideation, larger-than-life personalities and sheer skill have often helped executives rise to the top to

prestigious positions such as the CEO, for instance. However, weak communications skills tend to be their downfall. Additionally, the higher leaders move up the organisational ladder, the more they get cut off from the rest of the organisation. Customer and employee satisfaction often takes the backseat and ironically, the sheer time demands of being in

a leadership role can undermine their overall effectiveness as leaders. However, the position of a CEO mandates these individuals to actually listen to their consumers and employees. They must pay attention to who is saying what, suspend all kinds of judgement and listen as an impartial entity, reflect on the comments and feedback, clarify if needed, summarise and relay the feedback to the appropriate team in the company and finally, share their own opinion on the issue on hand.

A.G. Lafley, the former CEO of Procter & Gamble said, "Every CEO needs to the chief listening officer in the organisation - every day." Commitment to one of the most overlooked and underrated of leadership skills - communication - can enhance consumer-brand engagement, double up revenue and create a better working environment. Additionally, analysing brand mentions on social media, consumer sentiment, and future trends across the industry and target markets can ensure that the business stays ahead of its competition. Chief Listening Officers are increasingly becoming more integral to making this happen. The job is not exactly commonplace at the moment, but they are touted to be more so in the future. 



Dell and Kodak integrated Chief Listening positions in 2011

marketing. Any additional experience in social media or behavioural sciences would be quite helpful to make you a good hire in this field.

HOW DO THEY GO ABOUT THEIR JOB?

These professionals work for a wide array of organisations which also include global chain companies. They utilise traditional tools to gauge customer satisfaction such as surveys and focus groups, invoke social media 'listening' where they listen to customer's comments and feedback and relay everything back to the adequate